Washington University in St. Louis

DAT 5668: AGENTIC AI — AUTONOMOUS DECISION-MAKING

Fall 2026

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructors: Salih Tutun, PhD and Gerald Onwujekwe, PhD

Time/Location: Section 21 – In Person, 1.5 Credit Course (graduate offering; proposed BSBA cross-listing). Seven modules and 13 class meetings: Modules 1–6 are taught twice (two labs each); Module 7 (project) meets once.

For Fall 2026, passing times among the labs are 10 minutes. Teaching time has been set to 80 minutes per class session. The course has 13 meetings: six modules × two sessions plus one project session.

Course Email:

If students have any questions with respect to the course, please use our personal emails: salihtutun@wustl.edu.

Office Hours (Tentative):

Instructor Office Hours: Tuesday 1:00 pm - 2:00 pm (Simon Hall 289)
Thursday 1:00 pm - 2:00 pm (Simon Hall 289)
Individual meetings with the appointments

Course modality:

This course will be taught in the lab (in person). Office hours are in Simon Hall 289. A course Zoom link is available only for emergency situations; contact the instructor for the link.

COURSE SET-UP (FLIPPED CLASSROOM):
The course has seven modules and 13 in-person meetings (~80 minutes each). Modules 1–6 are each taught two times (Session 1 and Session 2). Module 7 is a single project/presentation meeting. Before meetings, students complete required video modules. Videos introduce the shared agent loop and the two implementations (LLM-based agents and RL-based agents); labs apply them in Python/Colab. MSA and BSBA students follow the same format.

VIDEO WATCHING AND ACCOUNTABILITY (including BSBA students): Students must watch assigned videos before lab. (1) A pre-lab Canvas quiz is due one hour before lab (late quizzes are not accepted except with an excused absence). (2) Canvas video/page completion is monitored each week. (3) The first ~10 minutes of lab recap the videos and include brief entry/cold-call questions. (4) Students who have not completed that week's quiz cannot receive full credit on the in-lab assignment. Repeated non-completion after a warning can reduce lab participation. An optional TA session is offered for setup and review, especially for undergraduates.

PREREQUISITES:

Graduate: DAT 5565 (Deep Learning for Predictions of Business Outcomes) or DAT 6565, or instructor permission. BSBA (proposed cross-listing): DAT 5565 or equivalent preparation (Python plus supervised ML/DL), or instructor permission. Co-requisites: none.

WHY THIS COURSE IS CROSS-LISTED FOR BSBA STUDENTS:
This course is already designed for Olin graduate analytics students and is proposed for the BSBA Major in AI and the Minor in Business Analytics and AI. It is not a graduate-only RL seminar moved into the undergraduate catalog. Specific undergraduate value: (1) Career-facing skill—BSBA students enter product, operations, consulting, and analytics roles that already ask how to design, buy, and govern AI agents (service, research assistants, document workflows, ops copilots). (2) Managerial questions—ROI, process design, human-in-the-loop control, vendor vs. build, evaluation against business KPIs, and accountability. (3) Elective-efficient sequencing—at 1.5 credits after Deep Learning, undergraduates can add agentic skills without consuming a full 3-credit technical elective. (4) Same labs as graduate students, with extra scaffolding in the videos on when not to automate and how to brief a technical vendor.

BUSINESS PERSPECTIVE (DISTINCT FROM RELATED MCKELVEY OFFERINGS):
Olin's Agentic AI course is applied AI for business. Every week starts from a firm use case (service operations, knowledge work, finance operations, supply chain) and ends with evaluation and governance. Engineering courses may go deeper on algorithms, systems, or research RL. We distinguish this course by buy-vs-build and workflow design, measurement against business metrics, risk/privacy/control, and communication to non-technical stakeholders. Students who want large-scale systems or compiler-level work should take McKelvey electives; students who want to deploy and manage agents in firms should take this course.

WHY LLM-BASED AGENTS AND RL-BASED AGENTS ARE TAUGHT IN THE SAME COURSE:
We teach both in DAT 5668 because they answer the same business question with different machinery. (1) Shared loop: observe → decide → act → feedback. (2) Shared design choices: goals, data, tools or actions, human checkpoints, and failure costs. (3) Shared evaluation: task success, cost, latency, safety, and KPIs—not demo quality. (4) Complementary fit: unstructured language and tools versus structured sequential reward. (5) Hybrids: many firm workflows will use an LLM for planning, retrieval, or exception handling and an RL (or other sequential) policy for repeated operational decisions. Splitting them into two electives would leave BSBA students with too little room and would hide the go/no-go choice the committee asked us to emphasize. Module 1 maps one process both ways; Module 6 compares and combines them; the project may be LLM, RL, or hybrid.

OLIN'S PILLARS OF EXCELLENCE

OLIN STUDENTS WILL:

- Embody a values-based and data-driven ethos in their approach to all business situations
- Understand the global opportunities and challenges facing businesses
- Engage with business issues through the application of experiential knowledge, in addition to the rigorous technical skills acquired in the classroom
- Pursue world-changing initiatives with an entrepreneurial and innovative mindset and skillset

COURSE MATERIALS:

Main book (deep RL weeks): Richard S. Sutton and Andrew G. Barto, Reinforcement Learning: An Introduction, 2nd ed., MIT Press, 2018 (print or free author PDF/HTML). Optional: Enes Bilgin, Mastering Reinforcement Learning with Python, Packt, 2020. LLM-agent weeks: instructor notes, Canvas notebooks, and selected practitioner readings on tool-using agents and RAG (updated each offering). Students are assessed on both agent families.

SOFTWARE:

Google Colab, Python, and instructor-specified agent/LLM libraries (plus TensorFlow/PyTorch only as needed). Students need a laptop. Course API keys or a documented free-tier workflow will be provided; students must not paste confidential data into public tools.

COURSE DESCRIPTION:

Agentic AI is the design of systems that act toward a goal in an environment: observe, decide, act, and use feedback. That loop is the same whether the "decider" is a large language model calling tools over documents and APIs, or a policy learned by reinforcement learning from repeated reward. This 1.5-credit course therefore teaches LLM-based agents and RL-based agents together—not as two unrelated electives, but as two implementations of one managerial problem: which work should be autonomous, how the agent should act, and how we evaluate and govern it. LLM agents fit knowledge work (retrieval, tools, multi-step workflows, handoffs). RL agents fit repeated sequential control (inventory, pricing, trading-style decisions) where a state, action, and reward can be specified. Industry systems increasingly combine them (for example, an LLM that plans or handles exceptions and an RL policy that executes a high-frequency decision). Students who see only one family mis-specify the other: a chatbot is a poor inventory controller; a DQN is a poor contract-reviewer. The course is applied AI for business, taught in 13 meetings, and is proposed for BSBA cross-listing as well as the existing graduate offering.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Explain the shared agent loop (observe–decide–act–feedback) and choose, with a business rationale, an LLM-based agent, an RL-based agent, or a hybrid for a given workflow.
- Build a prototype LLM agent with tool use and RAG, and evaluate grounding, cost, and human oversight.

- Formulate a sequential business problem as an MDP and apply tabular Q-learning (including exploration such as ε-greedy).
- Build and train a DQN agent with experience replay, diagnose failure modes, and compare it to baselines in an operations or trading-style case.
- Compare, combine, and govern both families (including a hybrid pattern) and write a short evaluation/governance note for managers.

- CREDIT HOURS AND WORKLOAD: Consistent with Olin standards, each credit hour requires at least 700 minutes of instructional time and about 28 hours of out-of-class work. For this 1.5-credit course, expect roughly ≥1,050 instructional minutes, delivered as 13 class meetings of ~80 minutes, and ≥42 hours of independent learning (readings, quizzes, programming homework, and project). Confirm final contact-hour schedule with the Registrar.

COURSE OUTLINE:

Mtg	Module	Title	Topics (detail)
1	1 / Sess. 1	The agent loop: why LLM and RL belong in one course	Observe–decide–act–feedback as the definition of an agent. When a business process should be autonomous vs. human. Two implementations of the same loop: (a) LLM-based agents that act through language, tools, and documents; (b) RL-based agents that act through a learned policy and reward. Cost of using the wrong family (chatbot for inventory; DQN for contract review). Managerial questions: goal, data, action space, feedback, human checkpoint.
2	1 / Sess. 2	LLM-based agents: prompting vs. agency and tool use	From a chatbot to an agent: goals, memory, and actions. Function calling / tools (search, database/CRM lookup, calculator, ticket system). Grounding vs. hallucination. Prototype: policy-checker or CRM-lookup agent. Failure modes of "just prompt it." When tool use is required for business reliability.
3	2 / Sess. 1	RAG, planning, and light multi-agent workflows	Retrieval-augmented generation over enterprise knowledge (policies, tickets, filings): chunking, retrieval quality, citations. Planning and short-term memory for multi-step tasks. Light multi-agent pattern (researcher / analyst / reviewer) and accountability for handoffs. Lab: RAG over a business document set; discuss retrieval errors as a management problem.
4	2 / Sess. 2	Sequential decisions and bandits (RL family)	Why some business problems are repeated decisions under uncertainty, not one-shot document tasks. Multi-armed bandits: exploration vs. exploitation (pricing tests, channel allocation, creative testing). Contrast with LLM agents: reward is numeric and frequent; state can be tabulated. Business cases and limitations of bandits.
5	3 / Sess. 1	Markov Decision Processes for business	States, actions, transitions, rewards, discounting. Formulating inventory, dynamic pricing, or simple trading/execution as an MDP. What must be true for RL to be appropriate (repeatability, definable reward,

			delayed consequences). Lab: write an MDP spec for a chosen operations problem; identify data you would need.
6	3 / Sess. 2	Lab: specify one firm process two ways	Students map a single business workflow (e.g., claims triage, replenishment, or pricing exceptions) once as an LLM-agent design (tools, knowledge, handoffs) and once as an MDP (states, actions, rewards). Deliverable: a one-page go/no-go memo arguing LLM, RL, hybrid, or "do not automate." Intro to Colab, course APIs, and lab norms.
7	4 / Sess. 1	Bellman equation, dynamic programming, Monte Carlo, TD	Value functions and the Bellman equation. Dynamic programming (policy/value iteration) when the model is known. Model-free ideas: Monte Carlo returns and temporal-difference learning. Intuition for managers: credit assignment over time. When DP is infeasible in real operations data.
8	4 / Sess. 2	Q-learning lab (tabular agents)	Q-learning, ε-greedy exploration, learning rates. Train and observe a tabular agent in a small business-style environment (grid/inventory toy or simplified pricing). Diagnostics: oscillation, under-exploration, misspecified reward. Connect back to Module 1: this is the "decide/act" box filled by a learned Q-table rather than an LLM.
9	5 / Sess. 1	Deep RL concepts: from Q-tables to neural policies	Why tabular Q-learning breaks in large state spaces. Policy-, value-, and model-based methods and trade-offs for business. Deep Q-Networks: function approximation, experience replay, target networks (conceptual). Stability, sample cost, and why firms often need simulators. Safety: reward hacking and off-policy risk in operations.
10	5 / Sess. 2	DQN lab: business decision / trading-style agent	Network design, preprocessing of market or operations features, train a DQN, compare to baselines (heuristics, myopic policy). Diagnose failure modes (divergence, poor exploration, distribution shift). Short business write-up: would you deploy, and what human override is required?
11	6 / Sess. 1	Hybrids: combining LLM agents and RL agents	Patterns used in practice: LLM as planner or exception-handler + RL (or rules) as high-frequency executor; RL policy that calls an LLM as a tool; LLM that proposes actions a controller must validate. Orchestration, latency, and who is accountable when two systems act. Mini-design: extend the Module 1 process into a hybrid architecture. Light return to multi-agent LLM roles where they complement RL.
12	6 / Sess. 2	Evaluation, KPIs,	Evaluate both families with the same managerial

		governance, buy vs. build	scorecard: task success, cost, latency, safety, grounding/hallucination (LLM) or unsafe actions/reward misspecification (RL), and business KPIs. Human-in-the-loop design. Auditability and data/privacy. Buy vs. build (vendor agents vs. in-house DQN/LLM stack). Clinic on failure cases. Sets up the project rubric.
13	7 / one session	Project presentations and wrap-up	Team presentations (~7 minutes). Project may be an LLM agent, an RL/DQN agent, or a hybrid, but must (a) state the agent loop, (b) justify the family chosen, (c) report evaluation vs. a baseline, and (d) include a short governance note. Written report due on Canvas. Course wrap-up and link back to DAT 5565 / next steps.

The table below lists all 13 meetings. Modules 1–6 have two lab sessions each; Module 7 is a single project meeting. Videos before class support the session topics. Exact dates are posted on Canvas and may adjust for the university calendar and holidays.

GRADING POLICY:

Category	Percentage
Lab Participation	5%
Quizzes	30%
In-Class Labs	15%
Homework (Programming Assignments)	20%
Project	30%
Total	100%

Quizzes: six pre-lab quizzes aligned to the weekly videos; the lowest score is dropped. If you submit assignments or projects late, Canvas will automatically decrease 10% of the grade for every day late. After five days, no late labs, assignments, or projects will be accepted. Pre-lab quizzes due before lab are not accepted late except with an excused absence. Please submit every assignment by the due date. Groups for labs/project: 1–3 students.

MAKE-UP POLICY: Typically, the deadlines are strict and no make-up opportunities are given beyond the late submission policy mentioned before. A submission can be re-scheduled provided a notice is given and accepted well before the deadline. Students who have excusable absences should contact the instructor to request special arrangements as soon as possible.

SESSION LENGTH AND ENTRY/EXIT PROTOCOLS:

Entry and exit to/from class will be carried out as follows:

- When and where possible, students arriving to class should utilize outside waiting areas, such as courtyards, until five minutes prior to the start of class in order to avoid congregating in close proximity of exiting students.
- At the end of class, students should exit the room while keeping physical distance. Students closest to the doors should proceed out first, with those farthest from the exit leaving last. The instructor will be the last to leave and facilitate an orderly transition between classes.
- Students should avoid loitering in areas where congestion may occur (i.e. faculty podiums, narrow hallways, or at the entrance and exits of buildings).

HOW TO SUCCEED IN THIS COURSE?

Practicing the recommended exercise problems and additional problems from the textbook is also highly recommended to be successful in this course.

Understanding lab examples, homework problems, and recommended practice problems are critical for your success. I urge you to take the time to learn not only how to solve them but how to quickly recognize the type of problem you have in-front of you and how you can present the **solution comprehensively**. This

skill only comes from practice. I urge you to complete all of the assigned homework and additional problems listed in your textbook at the end of each topic. Most of the homework assignments will be submitted on Canvas. Multiple attempts are usually permitted. Assigned homework will be graded. Even though most of the Canvas submissions are graded for the solution, remember how you arrived at it and how you interpret and represent the solution/report is important too.

Grading Policy

Grading in this course will follow the Olin grading guidelines. These guidelines recommend average ***GPAs in the range of 3.4–3.5.*** *These schoolwide targets are designed to promote consistency, fairness, and academic rigor across all courses in the program.*

Letter Grade	Usual Grade Distribution
A+	**30% - 40%**
A	
A-	
B+	30% - 60%
B	
B-	
C+	0% - 5%
C	
C-	
D+	0% - 0%
D	
F	0% - 0%

It is the student's responsibility to verify any grades posted on the Canvas are correct. Any request for change in grade and / or re-grading may not be considered if it was not made in writing (email) within **one week** after the graded material was returned.

HOW TO SUCCEED IN THIS COURSE:

(h) Attend each class session and be actively engaged. If you are not engaged, talk to the instructor during office hours to find ways to be excited about this course!

(h) Open yourself to learning the value of mathematical symbolism, mathematical modeling techniques, analytic arguments, and tight, self-consistent answers.

(h) Learn how to express your answers by including definition of notations, proper figures with labels, formula, appropriate steps, solution, and interpretation of the solution.

(h) In addition to each homework set, practice the recommended and other exercise problems for each topic. To feel confident about where you stand in the course, test your knowledge by doing these sample problems before attempting the homework. (Answers for odd numbered textbook problems are in the back of the textbook).

(h) On average (subject to vary depending upon individual's ability), **about six hours of effort per week is needed to be successful in this course**. **To become familiar with the Python software, about three hours of additional effort per week is needed.**

(h) Attend the optional help sessions if you are having difficulties. Make an appointment to meet with me if additional help is needed.

(h) Finally, if something doesn't make sense during my lecture, **ask a question**. Don't worry about what others may think, as they are probably unclear as well.

ATTENDANCE: I am committed to make the class time worthwhile for you. Students are expected to attend classes (on time) and be prepared to participate (e.g., prepare textbook, notes, tables, calculator, and be ready for discussions). Students will be held responsible for any material covered in class. Should you miss a class it is your responsibility to obtain the missing material from another student before you come to next class. If you know you are going to miss a class, send an email to me. If you happen to miss a class for unforeseen/unexpected (acceptable) reasons, you are expected to email and inform me as soon as possible. I upload completed notes and videos for almost all of the topics covered.

Exceptions to this course attendance policy because of a COVID-19 diagnosis, symptoms consistent with COVID-19, or exposure to a person with a confirmed or suspected COVID-19 diagnosis that requires quarantine or isolation will be made in collaboration between the student and instructor (details below).

MAKE-UP POLICY: Typically, no make-up assignments, quizzes, and project are given.

PROFESSIONALISM/CLASSROOM CONDUCT: A positive learning environment depends upon mature behavior. Among other things, this means arriving to class on time, listening quietly and respectfully when someone else is speaking, and using socially acceptable business language at all times. Appropriate steps will be taken to ensure this positive learning environment.
Usage of computers and cellphones (e-mailing, texting, chatting, browsing internet, working on other assignments, playing computer games, etc.) during the class is prohibited.

THINGS THAT ARE NOT EXPECTED TO BE USED IN CLASS: Cell phones, iPods and all other electronic devices EXCEPT calculators. Note taking on ipads or your computer is appropriate. A cell phone cannot be used to replace a calculator. If you need to tape the class, you need to obtain instructor's prior approval. **No recording devices are permitted in class.**

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY: I take matters of Academic Integrity seriously and expect that you will also do the same. The Olin Business School is a community of individuals with diverse backgrounds and interests who share certain fundamental goals. Primary among these goals is the creation and maintenance of an atmosphere conducive to learning and personal growth for everyone in the community.

Becoming a member of the Olin community is a privilege which brings certain responsibilities and expectations. The success of Olin in attaining its goals and in maintaining its reputation of academic excellence depends on the willingness of its members, both collectively and individually, to meet their responsibilities. All individuals associated with Olin should conduct themselves with the utmost integrity in all aspects of their life, both on and off campus.

Please refer to the *Olin Code of Conduct handbook* for specific responsibilities, guidelines and procedures regarding academic integrity.

I encourage you to ask me if you have any questions about any academic integrity issue that you may have, e.g., what's allowed in examinations, what does collaboration with other students mean.

(i) All individual assignments, quizzes, should reflect your own effort only! However, for homework assignments and non-submitted class material, discussion with other students is not only allowed, but is encouraged.

(i) Signing attendance for others or asking others to sign attendance for you is prohibited.

(i) Passing class notes, class handouts or homework solutions to students who have yet to take the course, who attend a different section or receiving material from such students is strictly prohibited.

(i) Similarly, having access to an archive of past course material beyond what is made available to you by the instructor is prohibited.

(i) Attending a different section of the class without instructor's prior approval is prohibited.

(i) Each and every member of the group is expected to contribute to the group assignment in an equitable manner. All group members are responsible for the academic integrity of the assignment.

(i) Plagiarizing (the misrepresentation of work done by others as being one's own work) is a violation of the Code of Conduct. Remember to cite all sources of information and ideas to prevent problems.

(i) Submitting similar assignments in more than one class requires approval of all faculty members involved.

(i) Using calculators to store information or downloading special software on calculator is prohibited. You are responsible to notify me (anonymously if you wish), if you suspect that improper behavior has occurred (during homework preparation or during in-class examinations). I will immediately investigate and if the charges have merit, I will bring the matter before the Disciplinary Committee.

As in the past, any indication of an Honor Code violation will result in swift academic disciplinary action.

UNIVERSITY WIDE GUIDELINES AND POLICIES

Academic integrity

In all academic work, the ideas and contributions of others (including generative artificial intelligence) must be appropriately acknowledged and work that is presented as original must be, in fact, original. You should familiarize yourself with the appropriate academic integrity policies of your academic program(s).

Use of Artificial Intelligence tools (e.g., Copilot, ChatGPT, DeepSeek) is not permitted unless an assignment explicitly allows it. In this course, some labs will require using course-approved LLM/agent APIs; that is not the same as using AI to write your homework for you. Acceptable: using the assigned agent stack when the lab requires it; using a tool when the prompt permits it and citing how it was used. Unacceptable: submitting AI-generated write-ups as your own; using unauthorized AI on quizzes; pasting confidential course or firm data into public tools.

Turnitin

In taking this course, students may be expected to submit papers and assignments through Turnitin for detection of potential plagiarism and other academic integrity concerns. If students do not have an account with Turnitin and/or do not utilize Turnitin when submitting their papers and assignments, the instructor may upload your paper or assignment to Turnitin for processing and review.

UNAUTHORIZED RECORDING AND DISTRIBUTION OF CLASSROOM ACTIVITIES & MATERIALS

The following applies to all students in my class: "Except as otherwise expressly authorized by the instructor or the university, students may not record, stream, reproduce, display, publish or further distribute any classroom activities or course materials. This includes lectures, class discussions, advising meetings, office hours, assessments, problems, answers, presentations, slides, screenshots or other materials presented as part of the course. If a student with a disability wishes to request the use of assistive technology as a reasonable accommodation, the student must first contact the Office of Disability Resources to seek approval. If recording is permitted, unauthorized use or distribution of recordings is also prohibited."

DISABILITY RESOURCES (DR)

WashU supports the right of all enrolled students to an equitable educational opportunity and strives to create an inclusive learning environment. In the event a physical or online environment, learning activity, or learning interaction results in barriers to your inclusion due to a disability, please contact WashU's Disability Resources (DR) to engage in a process for determining and communicating approved accommodations. As soon as possible after receiving an accommodation from DR, send me your WashU Accommodation Letter. Because accommodations are not applied retroactively, initiate your request to DR prior to, or at the beginning of, the academic term to avoid delays in accessing accommodations once classes begin. https://disability.washu.edu/ Feel free to stop by during the first two weeks to discuss any accommodations you may need. Students should sign up for proctored exams with DR

SEXUAL HARASSMENT AND ASSAULT

If you have experienced sex discrimination, sexual harassment or violence, we encourage you to speak with someone as soon as possible. If you choose to share this information with me, as an instructor I am required to report your disclosure to my department chair, dean, or the Gender Equity and Title IX Compliance Office. You may also reach out to the Relationship & Sexual Violence Prevention (RSVP) Center to receive confidential support and discuss your options. https://titleix.wustl.edu/students/confidentiality-resources-support/

RELIGIOUS HOLIDAYS

To ensure that accommodations may be made for students who miss class, assignments, or exams to observe a religious holiday, you must inform me in writing before the end of the third week of class, or as soon as possible if the holiday occurs during the first three weeks of the semester. For more information, please see the university's Religious Holiday Class Absence Policy.

We can find a list of religious holidays here: https://orsel.washu.edu/support/religious-spiritual-holidays/

EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS

Before an emergency affects our class, students can take steps to be prepared by downloading the WashU SAFE App. In addition, each classroom contains a "Quick Guide for Emergencies" near the door.

RESOURCES FOR STUDENTS

WashU provides a wealth of support services that address academic, personal, and professional needs. To start exploring resources that can help you along the way, please visit: Resources for Students.

Statement on Military Service Leave

WashU recognizes that students serving in the U.S. Armed Forces and their family members may encounter situations where military service forces them to withdraw from a course of study, sometimes with little notice. Students may contact the Office of Military and Veteran Services at (314) 935-2609 or veterans@wustl.edu and their academic dean for guidance and assistance. See: https://veterans.wustl.edu/policies/policy-for-military-students/.

Preferred Name and Personal Pronouns

WashU recognizes that many students prefer to use names other than their legal ones to identify themselves. In addition, in order to affirm each person's gender identity and lived experiences, it is important that we ask and check in with others about pronouns. This simple effort can make a profound difference in a person's experience of safety, respect, and support. See: Pronouns Information and Preferred Name.

Bias Reporting and Support System (BRSS)

WashU has a non-punitive process through which students, faculty, staff, and community members who have experienced or witnessed incidents of bias, prejudice, or discrimination against a student can report their experiences to the University's Bias Report and Support System (BRSS) team.

Center for Career Engagement (CCE)

The Center for Career Engagement provides one-on-one coaching, resources, programs and events to support the lifelong career success of all students and alumni. In addition to having your resume reviewed or fine-tuning your interviewing skills, the CCE invites you to work with us as partners at every stage of your career development as you reflect, learn and experiment. Our Certified Career Management Coaches will listen, ask questions, and provide resources to help you understand yourself, envision possibilities, prepare, search and apply, and engage in your career development.
You can select a career coach based on availability and alignment with one of our industry-aligned career communities or you can choose a coach in the Career Exploration community.

To make an in-person or virtual appointment:

1. Log in to Handshake
2. Click Career Center (left side tool bar)
3. Click Appointments.

The CCE is conveniently located in the Danforth University Center, Suite 110 with several additional office spaces across campus in Knight Hall 210, Bauer Hall 250, Steinberg Hall and Brown Hall.

Counseling and Psychological Services

The Center for Counseling and Psychological Services' professional staff members work with students to resolve personal and interpersonal difficulties, many of which can affect a student's academic experience. These include conflicts with or worry about friends or family, concerns about eating or drinking patterns, and feelings of anxiety, depression, and thoughts of suicide. Individual, Conjoint, and Group therapy are all provided in addition to referrals for off-campus support. Information can be found on the CCPS webpage.

The Division of Student Affairs also offers a telehealth program to students called TimelyCare. While students are encouraged to visit CCPS during business hours, this additional service also provides after-hours access to medical care and 24/7 access to mental telehealth care across the United States, with no cost at the time of the visit. 12 counseling visits are provided at no charge as well as a limited number of psychiatry appointments. Students who pay the Health and Wellness fee are eligible for this service. Additionally, see the mental health services offered through the RSVP Center.

WashU Cares

WashU Cares specializes providing referrals and resources, both on, and off campus for mental health, medical health, financial and academic resources by using supportive case management. WashU Cares also receives reports on students who may need help connecting to resources or whom a campus partner is concerned about. If I am concerned about a student, I will file a report here: https://carestream.washu.edu.

The Writing Center

The Writing Center offers free writing support to all WashU undergraduate and graduate students. Staff members will work with students on any kind of writing project, including essays, writing assignments, personal statements, theses, and dissertations. They can help at any stage of the process, including brainstorming, developing and clarifying an argument, organizing evidence, or improving style. Instead of simply editing or proofreading papers, the tutors will ask questions and have a conversation with the writer about their ideas and reasoning, allowing for a higher order revision of the work. They will also spend some time looking at sentence level patterns to teach students to edit their own work.

The Center is located in Mallinckrodt, and appointments are available days and evenings Sunday through Friday. Office staff hours are Monday through Friday 10:00am to 4:00pm. Students are seen primarily by appointment, with walk-ins accepted as the schedule allows. They also have dedicated walk-in hours for undergraduates on Tuesday and Wednesday afternoons. Both in-person and online appointments are available. To make an appointment, go to writingcenter.wustl.edu. Email: writing@wustl.edu.

The Learning Center

The Learning Center provides peer-led support programs, including course-specific mentoring and academic skills coaching (study and test-taking strategies, time management, etc.), that enhance undergraduate students' academic progress. Contact them at learningcenter@wustl.edu or visit ctl.wustl.edu/learningcenter to find out what support they may offer for your classes.

Center for Diversity and Inclusion (CDI)

The Center for Diversity and Inclusion (CDI) supports and advocates for all undergraduate, graduate, and professional school students. We foster belonging for all! Visit our website for more information and resources. The CDI consists of the following offices and is physically located in the Danforth University Center (DUC) Suite 150 and the Women's Building Room 102.

- Cross-Cultural Connections (CCxN) – DUC 150
- Office for International Student Engagement (OISE) – Women's Building 102
- Office for Religious, Spiritual and Ethical Life (ORSEL) – DUC 150
- Spectrum Office (LGBTQIA+ Support) – DUC 150

The Dialogue Across Difference (DxD) program at WashU prepares students to engage in dialogue across perspectives. Students use dialogue to understand each other and see differences as learning opportunities. DxD offers 1 credit 8-week dialogue courses for undergraduate students and workshops and programs open to all graduate, undergraduate, and professional students. Visit us in DUC 340 or our website to learn more about DxD

Gephardt Institute

Students play an essential role in a vibrant and functioning democracy. State and local elections take place throughout the year and have a direct impact on our communities. Visit vote411.org to find dates and

details of upcoming elections in every state. You can register to vote, request an absentee ballot, confirm your polling location, and get Election Day reminders at http://wustl.turbovote.org for any of the 50 states and Washington D.C. WashU students are considered Missouri residents, and eligible student voters can register to vote in the state of Missouri or their home state. You need to update your voter registration every time you move, even within the same city.

Whether or not you're eligible to vote, you can participate by encouraging your friends to register and vote, engaging your peers in local issues, and taking part in other civic and community engagement activities. For more resources on voting and other civic and community engagement opportunities, including Civic Action Week, please visit http://washuvotes.washu.edu and http://gephardtinstitute.washu.edu.

University Libraries

WashU Libraries include seven unique locations across the Danforth Campus, but they are much more than just beautiful, quiet spaces for studying and group work. The Libraries include librarians for every discipline on campus, with the expertise to work with you to develop research ideas and find the best resources to meet your needs; you are also encouraged to explore our research guides, tailored for each subject and available online. The Libraries hold over five million items in the collections—print books, journals, electronic resources, databases, and millions more accessible through interlibrary loan—and you can find it all at the search on our home page. Additional resources for students include special collections, data services, citation help, digital publishing, and more. Visit the Libraries website for more details about these and other ways that the Libraries are here to support your academic success.

Thank you. For any questions or clarifications pertaining to the syllabus, please reach out to your instructor team. Look forward to getting to know everyone this semester!

Best Regards,

Salih Tutun, PhD and Gerald Onwujekwe, PhD